

I Bind Unto Myself Today

Words: attributed to St. Patrick of Ireland (circa 387-466). Paraphrased by Cecil F. Alexander, 1889.
Music: 'St. Patricks Breastplate' Charles V. Stanford, 1902. Setting: "The English Hymnal", 1906.
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♩ = 120

The musical score is written for a four-part vocal choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. The key signature is D major (two sharps) and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 120. The score consists of two systems. The first system contains the first five lines of the hymn, with five different verses of lyrics. The second system contains the final two lines of the hymn. The piano accompaniment features a steady eighth-note pattern in the right hand and a more active bass line in the left hand. The lyrics are printed below the vocal staves, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across measures.

1. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The strong Name of the
2. I bind this day to me for - ev - er By pow - er of faith, Christ's
3. I bind un - to my - self the pow - er Of the great love
4. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The vir - - tues of the
5. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The pow - er of God to

Tri - - ni - - ty,
in - - car - - na - - tion;
cher - - u - - bim;
star lit heav - en,
hold and lead,

By in - - vo - - ca - - tion
His bap - - tism in the
The sweet "Well done" in
The glor - - ious sun's life
His eye to watch, His

The first system of the musical score consists of three staves. The top staff is a vocal line in treble clef, starting with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, an eighth note B4, and a quarter note C5. The second and third staves form the piano accompaniment in D major, with the right hand playing chords and the left hand playing a bass line of quarter notes.

The second system of the musical score consists of three staves. The top staff is a vocal line in treble clef, starting with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, and ending with a quarter note B4. The second and third staves form the piano accompaniment in D major, with the right hand playing chords and the left hand playing a bass line of quarter notes.

The third system of the musical score consists of three staves. The top staff is a vocal line in treble clef, starting with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, and ending with a quarter note B4. The second and third staves form the piano accompaniment in D major, with the right hand playing chords and the left hand playing a bass line of quarter notes.

same
riv - - - - er,
ho - - - - ur,
ray,
stay,

The first system of music consists of a vocal line and piano accompaniment. The key signature is D major (two sharps). The vocal line begins with a single note, D5. The piano accompaniment consists of a single chord, D5.

The second system of music consists of a vocal line and piano accompaniment. The key signature is D major (two sharps). The vocal line begins with a single note, D5. The piano accompaniment consists of a single chord, D5.

The third system of music consists of a vocal line and piano accompaniment. The key signature is D major (two sharps). The vocal line begins with a single note, D5. The piano accompaniment consists of a single chord, D5.

2. His burst - - - ing from the
3. Con - - - fes - - - sors' faith, A - -
4. The flash - - - ing of the
5. The wis - - - dom of my

The fourth system of music consists of a vocal line and piano accompaniment. The key signature is D major (two sharps). The vocal line begins with a single note, D5. The piano accompaniment consists of a single chord, D5.

up - pray - ers, the heav'n - ly way, His com - - ing
 wind's the pro - - phets' scrolls, All good - - - deeds
 guide, His shield to ward; The sta - - - ble of
 The word - - - ble of

7

6. Against the demon snares of sin,
 The vice that gives temptation force,
 The natural lusts that war within,
 The hostile men that mar my course;
 Or few or many, far or nigh,
 In every place and in all hours,
 Against their fierce hostility
 I bind to me these holy powers.
7. Against all Satan's spells and wiles,
 Against false words of heresy,
 Against the knowledge that defiles,
 Against the heart's idolatry,
 Against the wizard's evil craft,
 Against the death wound and the burning,
 The choking wave, the poisoned shaft,
 Protect me, Christ, till Thy returning.

8. Christ be with me, Christ within me,
 Christ behind me, Christ before me,
 Christ beside me, Christ to win me,
 Christ to comfort and restore me.
 Christ beneath me, Christ above me,
 Christ in quiet, Christ in danger,
 Christ in hearts of all that love me,
 Christ in mouth of friend and stranger.

9. I bind unto myself the Name,
 The strong Name of the Trinity,
 By invocation of the same,
 The Three in One and One in Three.
 By Whom all nature hath creation,
 Eternal Father, Spirit, Word:
 Praise to the Lord of my salvation,
 Salvation is of Christ the Lord.